In more technical terms, analysing the numbers behind the table above shows that over the past seventeen years, the Coffee Can Portfolio's returns within two standard deviations (i.e. the 95 per cent probability interval) have been positive for all holding periods of three years or more, and have been in excess of 9 per cent per annum for all holding periods of five years or more. In simple terms, it means that historical data suggests the Coffee Can Portfolio offers more than a 95 per cent probability of generating a positive return as long as investors hold the portfolio for at least three years. If held for at least five years, there is more than 95 per cent probability of generating a return greater than 9 per cent.